MalikTrades

PROFILE SHAPES

Read the shape, pick the setup

VP ACADEMY · 04

START HERE

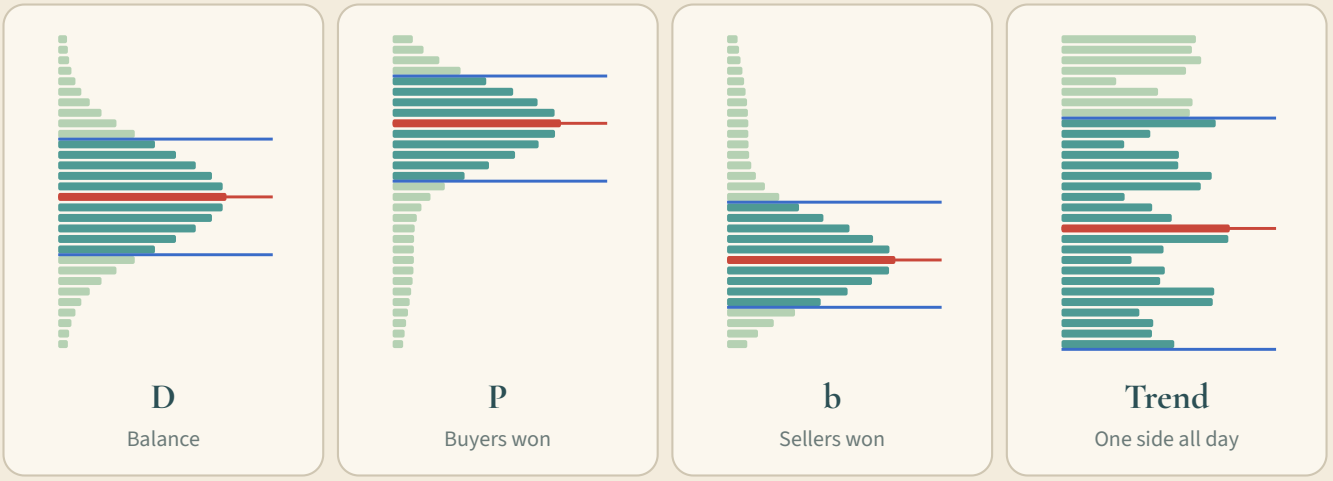
One idea

Where the volume built tells you who won.

The shape tells you who's in control.

In Volume Profile 101 you learned that volume builds where the market accepts a price. Step back and look at where it built across the whole profile, and you get its shape.

A fat middle means both sides agreed. Volume piled up at the top or bottom means one side won. A long, thin profile means one side was in control all day.



DURING YOUR SESSION

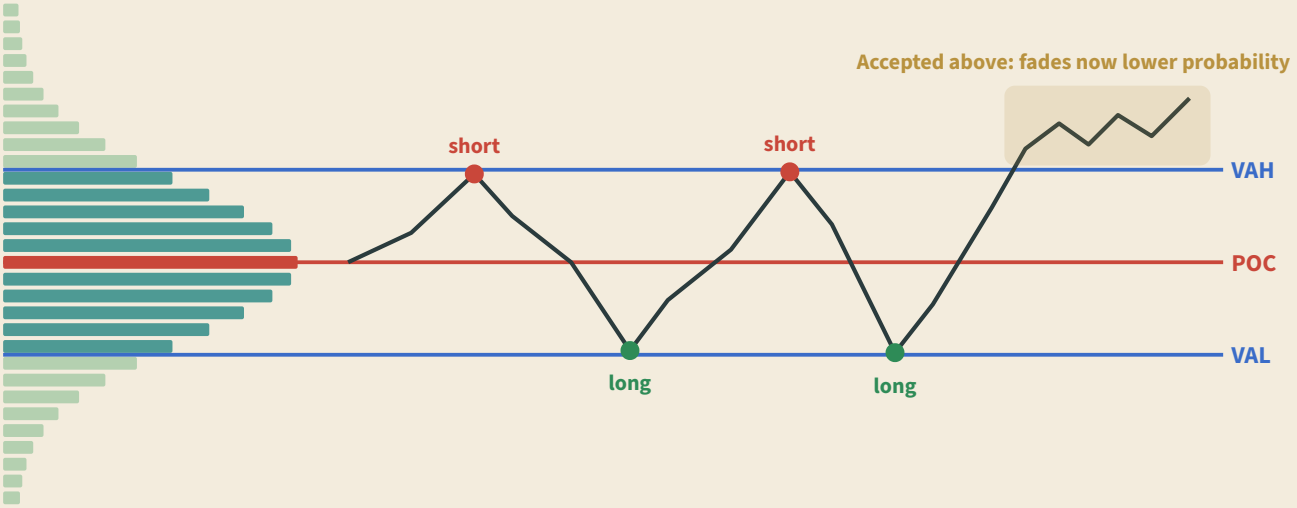
Watch the developing profile take shape. It tells you whether to keep fading the edges or switch to trading the breakout.

SHAPE 01

The D-Shape

Balance. My favourite to trade.

Fat in the middle, thin at both ends, with the POC near the centre. Buyers and sellers agree on value, so price keeps rotating inside the range instead of going anywhere.



How we trade it: the Snap 🤌

Short at the VAH, where it's expensive. **Long at the VAL**, where it's cheap. Target back towards value.

Then do it again. You can ping pong VAH to VAL for as long as the edges keep holding.

When the odds change

Price ranges just above the VAH or just below the VAL, and an HVN starts building there. The market is accepting new prices, so the balance is over.

From here, fades are **lower probability** and the **Flip** is higher probability.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Balance means fade the edges. Keep fading until the market accepts a price outside them.

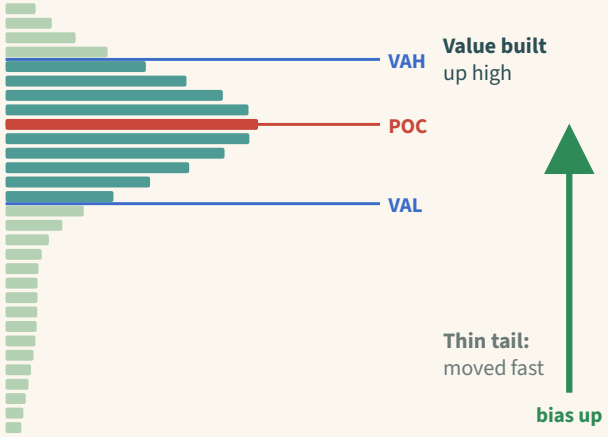
SHAPES 02 & 03

The P and b Shapes

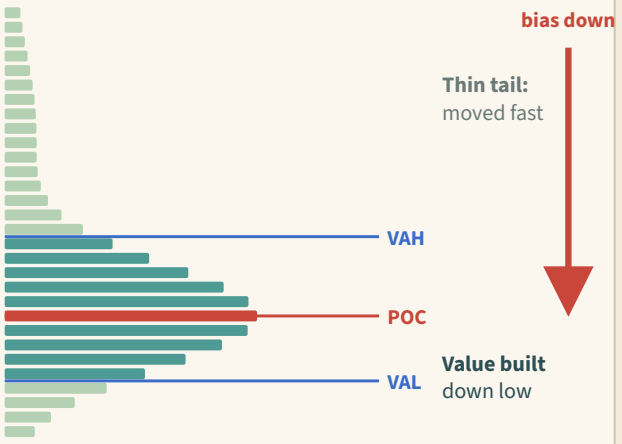
One side won, then the market settled.

These two are mirror images. Price moved hard one way and left a thin tail behind it, then stopped and built value at the new prices. The fat part is where the market settled. The thin tail is where it moved through fast.

P-shape



b-shape



P-shape: buyers in control

Lean long. Snap longs off the VAL and POC, where buyers are defending value. Fading the VAH is **lower probability**, since you're shorting against the side in control.

If price drops below the VAL and is accepted in the thin tail, it can move fast. **Flip short** on the retest.

b-shape: sellers in control

Lean short. Snap shorts off the VAH and POC, where sellers are defending value. Buying the VAL is **lower probability**, since you're buying against the side in control.

If price pushes above the VAH and is accepted in the thin tail, **Flip long** on the retest.

KEY TAKEAWAY

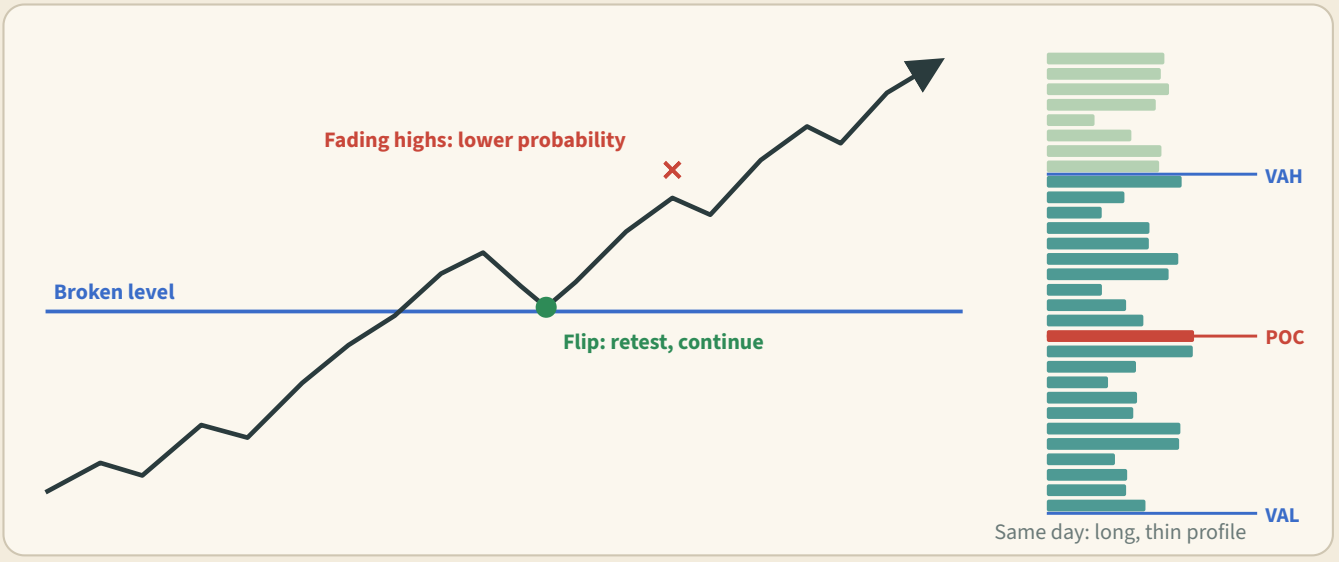
Trading with the side that built the value is higher probability. Fading against it is lower.

SHAPE 04

The Trend Profile

Long and thin. One side in control all day.

No real bulge. Volume is spread thin across a long range because price never stopped long enough to build value. Each new price was accepted, then left behind. These days often close near their high or low.



Same day: long, thin profile

Lower probability: fading it

Snaps against a trend are lower probability. The edge you fade tends to become the next level price breaks through.

Higher probability: trading with it

The Flip 🔄 A broken level, retested from the other side.

The Magnet 🧲 Accepted above the dVAH (or below the dVAL), back to the dPOC, then continue.

SPOT IT EARLY

On the developing profile, price keeps building volume above the dVAH or below the dVAL, and the dPOC keeps moving the same way. That's acceptance, and Snaps against it become lower probability.

CHEAT SHEET

Read the Shape, Pick the Setup

All four on one page.

SHAPE	WHO'S IN CONTROL	HIGHER PROBABILITY	LOWER PROBABILITY
 D	Neither. Balance	Snap both edges, ping pong VAH to VAL	Fading once an HVN builds outside value
 P	Buyers	Snap longs off the VAL and POC. Flip short if accepted below the VAL	Shorts at the VAH
 b	Sellers	Snap shorts off the VAH and POC. Flip long if accepted above the VAH	Longs at the VAL
 Trend	One side, all day	Flip and Magnet, with the trend	Snaps against it

Want to see a D-shape fade in action? My trade from this session is in #setup-library.

Education only, not financial advice.